Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	Environmental Systems and Societies		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	To what extent do the inputs and outputs of water at the Dead Sea, Israel, allow a sustainable withdrawal of water by the chemical industry from 2000 to 2020?		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**3**	The research question (RQ) regarding the water balance in the Dead Sea and its use in the chemical industry is a relevant topic of investigation. However, it is only partially focused, as the essay lacks data on industrial usage impacting the scope of the RQ. While the research method is generally suitable, its simplicity compromises the quality of the data. Nonetheless, the essay is well-structured, allowing for efficient communication of the research findings.	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The candidate uses a range of relevant research materials, including newspapers and government reports. Some of these sources had to be translated. The terminology is simple but correctly used, demonstrating an understanding of the concepts within the systems and societies component. Although some concepts regarding the water balance of the Dead Sea are explained and applied, they lack depth and detail.	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The essay includes an analysis using a systems approach, with a simple model developed by the student. Although important factors are not accounted for in the model, the candidate establishes a partially consistent line of argument that connects the research question with the calculations and conclusions.	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**3**	The candidate discusses the data obtained from the calculations and its implications for the water balance model. The significance of the findings is occasionally supported by appropriate evidence. However, while some comments are made regarding the usefulness of the results, the strengths and limitations of the research are not adequately addressed.	

E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**3**	The candidate reflects on the overall learning experience during the extended essay process, citing specific examples. The candidate also highlights academic growth, such as learning to work effectively with secondary data. More emphasis could be on transfer.
Total marks awarded	17 /30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	This essay investigates the water balance of the Dead Sea in Israel and its impact on the chemical industry. The candidate develops a simple systems model to evaluate the main inputs and outputs of the Dead Sea. Basic calculations are provided, and the results are analyzed. However, many relevant factors, such as quantitative data for the chemical industry, are not considered in the model.	